E2 DAMA-DMBOK applied to talent data

The eleven knowledge areas, governance at the hub, and an evidence-based maturity baseline across talent domains.

E2-L1 The DAMA wheel, eleven knowledge areas around governance

Name the knowledge area before you name the fix. Governance at the hub assigns an owner to each area, so problems reach the person who can solve them.

DAMA wheel	Data governance at the hub, ten knowledge areas around it. DMBOK2, revised in 2024.
DMBOK2 definition of data governance	The exercise of authority, control and shared decision-making (planning, monitoring and enforcement) over the management of data assets.
Reference data, master data, metadata	Reference: lists of codes. Master: the agreed record of a core entity. Metadata: data about data.
First move on any data problem	Name the knowledge area, then its owner, then the fix.

E2-L2 A maturity baseline you can defend

Score a grid of knowledge areas by talent domain, in whole levels, with evidence for each score, and report the weakest area per domain.

A common 0 to 5 maturity scale	0 none, 1 initial, 2 repeatable, 3 defined, 4 managed, 5 optimised. Agree and version the names with stakeholders.
The baseline grid	Knowledge areas by talent domain: workforce, recruitment, learning, performance, mobility, skills.
Summarise a domain by	Its weakest area and score. A mean hides gaps.
A defensible score	A whole level with cited evidence: a document, a metric or a log.

E2-L3 Governance at the hub, decision rights, policies and escalation

Separate deciding from doing. Name a decider for each kind of decision, write rules as policy, standard and procedure, and log each decision with its reason.

Governance against management	Governance decides and oversees. Management does the work.
Decision rights to name first	Definitions, access to sensitive fields, quality thresholds, and new uses of data.
Policy, standard, procedure	Policy: what and why. Standard: measurable. Procedure: how. Each changes at its own pace.
Escalation path	Data steward, data owner, governance council. Log every decision with its reason.

E2-L4 People master data, match rules and survivorship

Match in bands, with only deterministic keys merging automatically. Choose each field's value by a written rule, never let a blank win, and keep the cross-reference.

Deterministic or probabilistic matching	Deterministic: exact keys, easy to explain, misses typos. Probabilistic: similarity score, catches more, makes false matches.

Match bands	Merge above a high score, keep apart below a low one, and send the middle band to a data steward.
Common survivorship rules	Source priority, most recent, most complete. A blank never overwrites a value.
Why keep a cross-reference?	Later deliveries find their person by source ID, and a false merge can be undone.